

The 6:15

SUNDAY · SEPTEMBER 20, 2026

NO. 17

THE BOARD

CALENDAR (WEEKEND EDITION — CONDENSED)

Today

Yankees close their series at Arizona, 4:10p ET (Warren vs. Rodríguez), having split the first two — see Transactions. Iran claims Oman has agreed a plan to reopen the strait; Oman has not confirmed it **[DEVELOPING]** — see Lead.

Wk of 9/22

Durable goods orders, final Q2 GDP, existing home sales, and wholesale inventories cluster with initial claims ~9/25; PCE (the Fed's preferred gauge) ~9/26 — dates now cross-checked against a second weekly preview this run, still not sourced directly to a BLS/BEA calendar **[dates indicative]**. Mon 9/28: SpaceX targets Starship's first orbital flight (Flight 14) from Starbase, 8:15-9:30a ET window, carrying 26 Starlink V3 satellites — pending FAA sign-off **[NEW/forward]**. OPEC+'s JMMC meets in October, the last review before 2027 quota talks; exact date not confirmed this run.

Economics and Technology carry nothing new verified this run and are cut for this weekend edition — see Continuity.

METRICS (WEEKEND EDITION — CONDENSED) · AS OF FRI 9/18 CLOSE UNLESS NOTED; NO NEW SETTLE SINCE (WEEKEND)

Oil/rates/vol

Brent \$103.87 (-0.9%, issue No. 16); a separate tracker checked this run puts the same Friday session at \$102.41 (-2.3%) — a third, still-unreconciled figure for that close **[gap widens]**. WTI \$100.30 (-1.6%), consistent across sources checked this run. 10Y ~4.94% Fri, down from Tue 9/15's intraday 5.02% — the highest since 2007 **[NEW]**. DXY 99.98; VIX 14.81; gold \$4,415.90 (record).

Equities/other

Dow 51,682.64 (-0.18%); S&P 500 7,650.50 (+0.17%); Nasdaq Comp. 26,522.55 (+0.39%) — all Fri close, unchanged since issue No. 16. Retail gas \$4.4687/gal

natl. avg (AAA, Fri). 2Y and 30Y not confirmed as of press time **[unverified]**.

Crude: ICE Brent/NYMEX WTI front-month. Rates: Fed H.15/CME. Equities: exchange closes/CNBC/Bloomberg.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Fire pause

One war tracker puts the land-side pause at 10 days through Fri 9/19 — no Iranian missile or drone attack on a host state since the Sept. 8-9 Muwaffaq Salti barrage (20 missiles), no drone attacks in 14 days **[NEW, single-sourced this run]**. That's a separate ledger from the strait itself: Wednesday/Thursday's tanker incidents (issue No. 16) continued on the water through the same window — land and sea moving in opposite directions.

Iran-Oman claim

FM Araghchi says Iran and Oman have agreed a plan to reopen the strait; no Omani official has confirmed it as of this run **[DEVELOPING, unconfirmed]**. Distinct from the multilateral Salalah meeting, still postponed with no new date (issues No. 15/16).

Transits

Four more unreconciled counts surfaced this run — Reuters 4 transits Sept. 15; Windward 12 transits Sept. 16 (matches the high end of Kpler's already-flagged split); IMF PortWatch 8 transits Sept. 13 against an 85/day pre-crisis baseline; US Energy Secretary Wright cited 18M bbl moved "with US assistance" the prior day and an 11M bbl/day seven-day average. Four sources, four different units, none reconciled.

Dark tankers/AIS

A separate estimate checked this run puts dark (AIS-off) transits at roughly 57% of the conflict-period total, peaking at 65.2% in May — a percentage-of-total measure, not the straits.live vessel-count series (stuck since issue No. 14 at 490) it stands in for here for lack of a fresher count **[gap, methodology switch noted]**.

War-risk premia

No fresher print located this run; carrying issue No. 16's 3%-10% of hull-value range (~\$21M high end on a \$210M VLCC).

Reuters', Windward's, PortWatch's, and Sec. Wright's transit figures; the AIS dark-fleet percentage; and the hull-value premia range all measure different things over different windows and units (vessel counts, barrels, percentages, dollars) — never netted or averaged.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Split the first two at Arizona — won Fri. 9/18, 9-2 (Gerrit Cole; Ben Rice's 39th HR), resolving issue No. 16's unconfirmed box score, then lost Sat. 9/19, 5-3 on Pavin Smith's two-run ninth-inning homer. 89-65 through Saturday, holds the AL's top wild-card spot. Series finale today, 4:10p ET.
Knicks	No reported moves in the last 24 hours; Towns/Hart situation unchanged from issue No. 16.
Northwestern	Beat Colorado 41-7 Sat. 9/19 at Martin Stadium, the program's last game there before the Ryan Field move. Wildcats 2-0.

LEAD

LAND QUIET, SEA NOT

The fire pause hits double digits on land — the strait stays a war zone at sea, and Iran says Oman is on board with reopening it

Two clocks are running on the Iran war, and this weekend they read differently. On land, one war tracker's count puts the pause in Iranian attacks on host states at 10 days through Friday, the last confirmed launch a 20-missile barrage at Muwaffaq Salti on Sept. 8-9, with no drone attacks reported in 14 days. [NEW, single-sourced this run] At sea, the clock hasn't stopped: issue No. 16 covered Wednesday and Thursday night's tanker incidents inside the strait — an unidentified-projectile strike UKMTO attributed to no one in particular, and the IRGC's claimed attack on the Togo-flagged *Trend* — and nothing checked this run walks either back. [continuity] The two ledgers are not the same measurement, and treating a quiet week on the missile count as a quiet week in the strait would be a mistake this data doesn't support. [read]

Into that gap steps a claim worth flagging rather than accepting. Iranian Foreign Minister Araghchi said this weekend that Iran and Oman have agreed a plan to reopen the strait to normal traffic; as of this run, no Omani official has confirmed it. [DEVELOPING] That's a different track from the multilateral Salalah meeting Saudi Arabia postponed on Sept. 13 and that still has no rescheduled date (issues No. 15/16) — this is a bilateral Iran-Oman claim, and Tehran has made similar claims before without Omani corroboration following through on the timeline promised. [read] Worth remembering the mechanics if it is real: earlier reporting on the Iran-Oman framework described a temporary corridor beginning and ending in Iranian territorial waters, with Tehran empowered to bar American and Israeli vessels and fine violators up to 20% of cargo value — a structure that would leave Iran, not a neutral authority, controlling access to a strait carrying roughly a fifth of the world's oil. [read] None of that is confirmed for this specific claim; it's context for what "reopening" would mean if Araghchi's version holds up. [flag]

The market, for its part, is still pricing the quiet ledger. Friday's close — VIX at 14.81, the S&P at a fresh push higher, Brent and WTI both lower on the week (see Metrics) — reflects a tape that has treated the strait as background noise since at least issue No. 16's Friday read, and nothing checked this run gives a reason that's changed. [continuity/read] That's the same setup flagged twice now: a five-week gap to the next FOMC decision (Oct. 27-28) during which the market is betting the Saudi/Omani supply-workaround story holds, against a strait where the shooting hasn't stopped and where this run's transit data (four sources, none of them agreeing — see Hormuz counters) can't even confirm how much oil is actually moving through it day to day. [read] A 10-day pause in one category

of attack is real information. It is not, on this week's evidence, information about the category investors are pricing off of. [read]

POLITICS

President Trump followed through Friday on a threat to bar CNN, Politico, and MS NOW from the White House, and the restriction took effect Saturday: reporters from all three outlets — CNN's Betsy Klein, MS NOW's Akayla Gardner, Politico's Cheyenne Haslett — described badges disabled or confiscated at the gate. [NEW, multi-sourced: ABC News, NPR, Deadline, Politico] Trump's Truth Social post cited years of "FICTION and LIES" in the outlets' coverage. [quote] The White House Correspondents' Association called it a First Amendment violation and demanded access be restored; none of the three outlets had been reinstated as of this run. [fact] No litigation has been filed yet that this run located. [flag]

BUSINESS

FedEx reported fiscal Q1 2027 results (quarter ended Aug. 31): revenue of \$22.2B, up 3.1% year-over-year and above the \$21.74B consensus; adjusted EPS of \$3.83 beat the \$3.71 estimate. [NEW — resolves the pending flag carried in issues No. 15/16] Full-year guidance of \$17.20-\$19.00 EPS (midpoint below the \$18.29 consensus) and \$91.4B-\$93.2B revenue (above the \$89.1B consensus) came with the Freight spinoff still on track for completion by June 2026. [fact] The beat-and-mixed-guide combination is a read on domestic and cross-border shipping demand holding up better than expected even as full-year earnings guidance stays conservative — a data point for the "soft landing vs.

slowdown" debate this issue has tracked via housing and consumer prints, not a resolution of it. [read]

GEOPOLITICS

Russian strikes on Sumy continued past Friday's residential-building bombing (issue No. 16): a separate FPV drone strike killed four in the region Sept. 19, per Ukrainian reporting checked this run — a different incident from Friday's, not a revised casualty count for it. [DEVELOPING, single-sourced this run] Separately, the US Army awarded a \$10.6M contract for Ukrainian-made Raybird reconnaissance drones, which have logged more than 350,000 combat hours since the invasion began — a small-dollar but continuing signal of US procurement integration with Ukrainian industry. [NEW, single-sourced this run] The bipartisan Russia energy-sanctions bill flagged in issue No. 16 as reaching Trump's desk has no confirmed signing timeline as of this run. [continuity/flag]

IRAN & HORMUZ

Beyond the fire-pause/Oman-claim split covered in the Lead, the Salalah track remains stalled: no new date, and issue No. 16's dueling accounts of who drove the postponement — Iran says Saudi Arabia asked for it, Oman's Albusaidi called it mutual — are unresolved this run. [continuity] The strait has remained under partial Iranian closure since the US-Israel air war began Feb. 28; that baseline hasn't shifted in either direction this run. [continuity]

SPORTS

Yankees	Split at Arizona — won 9-2 Fri., lost 5-3 Sat. 89-65, top AL wild card; series finale today, 4:10p ET.
Knicks	No reported moves in the last 24 hours. Towns/Hart situation unchanged from issue No. 16.

Northwestern

Beat Colorado 41-7 Sat.; Chiles threw 3 TD passes, ran in 2 more. Wildcats 2-0; last game at Martin Stadium before the Ryan Field move.

Weekend edition. Calendar and Metrics ran condensed; Economics and Technology were cut (nothing verified this run). Politics and Business carried new material and were not cut.

Continuity. Not refreshed this run: OPEC+'s exact October JMMC date; a fresher war-risk-premia print; the Salalah reschedule date; the Nvidia-Hugging Face deal, Amazon FTC ad-auction suit, Ford/CATL battery scrutiny, Anthropic IPO timeline, and the OpenAI-Anthropic Navier-Stokes dispute (no new development located). No AI-model or VC-funding item fell inside the prior 24-48h window this run (OpenAI's Astra shipped Sept. 3; Sling Therapeutics' \$123M round was Sept. 16 — both outside the window, both skipped rather than repeated). Watch for next issue: whether Oman confirms or denies Araghchi's reopening claim; today's Yankees finale and AL wild-card math; Starship Flight 14's Sept. 28 window; confirmation (or non-) of the Russia sanctions bill's signing.

Unverified figures are marked in red. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.